John Juneau

Economics Ph.D. Candidate

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LinkedIn

Education

University of California, San Diego — San Diego, CA
Ph.D. in Economics, expected June 2027 — *2021–Present*

Washington and Lee University — Lexington, VA
B.A. in Economics with honors — *2014–2018*
Minors in Mathematics and Poverty and Human Capability Studies

Fields

Macroeconomics, Labor Economics, Spatial Economics

Research

Job Market Paper

Of Fathers and Farms: How Intergenerational Persistence Shapes Structural Transformation

Uses linked father–son records from historical U.S. Census microdata and a model of structural change to estimate how inherited skills and preferences shape sector choice across generations. The model accounts for endogenous selection and estimates these mechanisms from observed sector choices and earnings distributions. Counterfactual simulations imply that intergenerational persistence slowed U.S. industrialization from 1880 to 1940 by 23.2 percent, almost entirely through inherited skills; omitting persistence also substantially overstates the relative nonagricultural technology growth needed to explain the transition.

Publication

Sprouting Cities: How Rural America Industrialized — 2023
with Fabian Eckert and Michael Peters
AEA Papers and Proceedings, Volume 113, pp. 87–92. Examines how the emergence of new cities in rural America contributed to the U.S. transition from agriculture to industry.

Work in Progress

The Stimulative Effect of State Tax Cuts Across the Income Distribution
with Byron Lutz
Uses thirty years of detailed income-tax-return microdata and multiple panel-data research designs, including event-study local projections, to estimate how the distributional targeting of state income-tax changes affects employment. Finds positive employment responses to broadly targeted tax cuts, with no corresponding evidence for cuts targeted at the highest-income households.

College Wage Premia and Tradable Services
with Fabian Eckert

Technical Skills

Programming and analysis: Stata, R, MATLAB, Excel, LaTeX (advanced); Python and FAME (basic)

Methods: panel-data methods, event studies, local projections, structural estimation and calibration, counterfactual analysis, large-scale microdata construction

Languages: English (native), Spanish (basic)

Experience

Federal Reserve Board of Governors — Washington, DC
Summer Dissertation Fellow; Senior Research Assistant, Fiscal Analysis — *2025; 2018–2021*

- Maintained and analyzed databases of government receipts and outlays and supported projections of fiscal and macroeconomic indicators, including fiscal impetus and the primary deficit.
- Constructed and cleaned data and conducted statistical and econometric analysis, programming, and visualization for research projects in the Division of Research and Statistics.
- Independently carried out substantive empirical analysis and collaborated with professional economists on fiscal-policy research.
- Returned in 2025 as a Summer Dissertation Fellow to advance independent research on labor reallocation and long-run economic change.

University of California, San Diego — San Diego, CA
Research Assistant for Fabian Eckert — *2022*

Brookings Institution — Washington, DC
Research Assistant for Carol Graham — *2017*

Washington and Lee University — Lexington, VA
Research Assistant for Katie Shester and Chris Handy — *2016–2018*

Awards and Honors

TA Excellence Award, University of California, San Diego	2024
Graduate Research Fellowship, National Science Foundation	2021
Special Achievement Award, Federal Reserve Board of Governors	2020
Kim Family Prize, Washington and Lee University	2018
QuestBridge National College Match, Washington and Lee University	2014

Teaching

University of California, San Diego — San Diego, CA
Teaching Assistant — *2021–Present*
Graduate Macroeconomics; Long Run Macroeconomics; Short Run Macroeconomics; Market Imperfections and Policy. Practitioner in Student-Centered College Teaching certificate.

Federal Reserve Board of Governors — Washington, DC
Project Coordinator and Teaching Assistant, Howard University Data Analysis Course — *2018–2020*

Washington and Lee University — Lexington, VA
Teaching Assistant, Econometrics and Introduction to Statistics — *2016–2018*